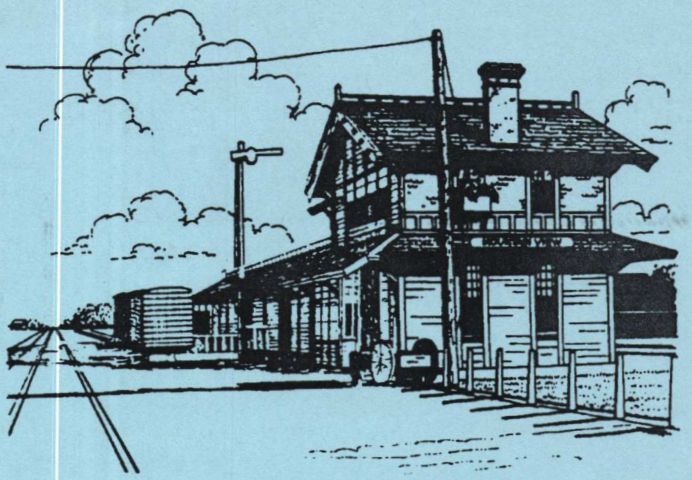
Mountain View Historical Association Newsletter

P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042

Hilton U. Brown, III - Editor



Southern Pacific Depot — Mountain View, California, built in 1888

Centennial Party Celebrating Mountain View
The November Meeting

At our November 2001 meeting we celebrated the restoration of the Adobe. This year we will celebrate the Centennial of the incorporation of Mountain View. President Faravelli is baking a cake and arranging a panel to talk about Mountain View's first hundred years, with emphasis on the City's own celebration. We will hold our biennial election of Historical Association Officers, revel in the Adobe Building, and perhaps glance across Central Expressway at the Train Depot. The Association has played a significant role in reviving interest in Mountain View's past and this is a chance to revel in the things we have helped to accomplish.

Come join us for cake and coffee and a little show of civic pride.

Don't Forget to Vote!
Tuesday
November 5, 2002

Barbecue & Raffle
The August Meeting

The *Ninth Annual Barbecue & Raffle* for the Mountain View Historical Association took place Sunday, August 4, 2001 at the Adobe Building. It was probably the largest attendance in the series, in part I am sure, due to the ambiance of the Adobe Building and its grounds. Thanks for all of the volunteers whose efforts made the event a success

MVHA 2002 Elections
Report of the Nominating Committee

It is time to elect MVHA officers for the 2003/2004 biennium. In accordance with our bylaws, a nominating committee was selected at the August meeting, charged with selecting aslate of candidates for MVHA Office. The Nominating Committee consisted of Ralph Faravelli (Chair), Edna Thompson and Wally Erichsen. The committee nominees are as follows:

President	***Craig Holden***
Vice President	***Pat Figueroa***
Secretary	***Margaret Peterson***
Treasurer	***Hilton Brown***

The bylaws specify that nominations for each office may be made from the floor at the annual meeting.

Therefor, if you are a member of the Association and would like to nominate someone else for any of the Association offices, feel free to do so.

Ninth Annual Barbecue & Raffle Accounting

August 3, 2002

Income:		
103 Adults	$ 1,030.00	
Raffle Proceeds	360.00	
Total Income		$ 1,030.00
Expenses:		
Food	$ 45.00	
Printing - Flyers	89.39	
Postage	120.25	
Total Expense		$ 254.64
Profit:		$ 1,135.36

There would be no profit without the hard work and dedication of our many volunteers and the generous support of the merchants and individuals who contributed gift certificates and food to our annual fund raiser.

Old Newspaper Items Compiled By Barbara Kinchen

100 Years Ago (1902): A reception was given students at the newly opened high school at Calderon Road and El Camino Real. A musical and literary program was presented, followed by ping pong games and refreshments. Rooms and halls were decorated in red and lighted with red Japanese lanterns.

Voting for incorporation of Mountain View took place on Saturday, November 1. Eighty four voted in favor and sixty four against. Elected to the Board of Trustees (Council) were Dr. C.O. Gates, D.B. Frink, George Pattbery and George Swall.

Native sons of the Golden West organized a parlor with 24 members.

Victor Anzini purchase the Junction Inn, corner of Moody Road (El Monte) and El Camino Real, and hoped to make it an attractive family resort.

75 Years Ago (1927): The new California Apartments, Hope and California, built by Minton Company, were advertized as "six of the most modern and completely equipped apartments in Santa Clara County" with new and improved Rip Van Winkle wall beds, electric ranges, garbage chutes, steam heat, radio plug connections and Frigerator refrigerators.

Watkin Evans, night policeman, was made Chief of Police and Wilson Brinton was hired to bring the force up to three.

The Chamber of Commerce was preparing a petition asking for Souther Pacific to build a new train station at the corner of Castro Street and the tracks, a block north of the present depot. Objections were because of mud holes I the parking lot, absence of cement walks and the fact there were no paved streets leading to the station.

The public was invited to visit the new Ramona Rabbity at the Junction. It specialized in fresh killed grin fed rabbits.

Lawson Brothers celebrated six years in Mountain View. Three prizes were offered for the three nearest guesses to the time it would take for pigeons release at the store to fly to their loft in Santa Cruz. The pigeons were owned by Sperry Flour Company.

50 Years Ago (1952): James H. Thomas, City Administrator here for over six years, was named the first City Manager under the new Charter. He will also act as Finance Director until the end of the fiscal year. Thomas appointed Arthur C. Nielsen as Chief of Police and Clarence Lawson as Fire Chief.

Ringlee's Yardage opened at 216 Castro Street and featured flannelette for 39¢ a yard.

Council denied permission for a card room to open in the 100 block of Castro Street. Chief Nielsen and twelve businessmen in the block had recommended a permit not be give because of the four bars, two

package liquor stores and one card room already there.

Pasarow Foods Company of Lo Angeles bought the Hunt Foods plant (pickle works) in Mountain View.

The Sunnyvale club on Escuela Avenue (Senior Citizens Center now) invited the public to Saturday night dances in the ballroom and family-style dinners Sunday evenings.

25 Years Ago (1977): Residents responded to need to conserve water during drought conditions by using 26% less water than in 1976, therefore mandatory rationing will not be required.

Millard Sheets, famed architect and artist from Clarement, is responsible for the 31 foot mural being installed on the front of the new Home Savings Bank building on El Camino. The mural shows the history of Mountain View.

City Hall now has a Hewlett-Packard HP300011 computer and ten display terminals. The first program fed into the data bank was a fire incidents system, a planning tool for the fire department.

Mountain View Historical Association celebrated the 75th birthday of Mountain View's incorporation at the Community Recreation Center with a birthday cake and exhibit of memorabilia and photo graphs. Ana Jagels Lew, Eileen Gariepp Berryessa, Ethel Emerson and Manuel Vargras told about early days and Assemblyman Victor Calvo presented a resolution from the State Legislature congratulating the City. Certificates were presented to nearly 50 individuals who had been residents here in 1902.

Notice - Dues are Due!

See page six for details

Street Talk
By Barbara Kinchen

The August *Street Talk* question was:: In 1902 the county was asked to "layout, open and maintain a public road" to run from Fremont Avenue, on the bank of Permanente Creek, north to the San Francisco Road opposite Castro Street. This became Miramonte Avenue, but originally how was it written?

The Answer: Our present Miramonte Avenue was originally Mira Monte. The local chapter of Eastern Star, organized in 1896, is Mira Monte Chapter. In 1931 a new building was constructed opposite the Castro Street High School. It was named Mira Monte Court and contained six stores and two apartments. Lane's Creamery was in one of the front stores when I was in school, a popular place for students at lunch time and after school. (Editor's note: *El Camino Real* was known as the *San Francisco Road* at the turn of the last century).

New Question: On early maps Bush Street had a different name. What was it called.?

Members, how about contributing to *Street Talk* ?

Mountain View Time Line
Comments & Addendum

The four page *Mountain View Time Line*, included with the May 2002 MVHA Newsletter has brought forth several suggestions, corrections, criticisms and additions which we shall review, study and ponder with a view to revising and republishing the *Time Line* next year. Please make note of any ideas or suggestions that you may have to make this an ever more useful and accurate document. Pass your thoughts on to Carol Fischer or Barbara Kinchen at the History Center, or mail them to your editor. If you have misplace your copy, you can pick up a replacement at the Mountain View Library History Center.

Relative to this, I have received a very interesting note from Godfrey Baumgartner Jr., a 71 year

resident of Mountain View. Godfrey, depending in part on boyhood memories and in part on research at NASA Ames reports that as a boy, he could barely see the actual first wind tunnel from the top of the water tank tower on his family farm located at what is now Evelyn Avenue and Highway 85. That wind tunnel was built in 1940-1941 and played an important role in the superiority of American aircraft in the war. The big wind tunnel, the 40 by 80 foot tunnel, the largest in the world, was built in 1944. Godfrey viewed the erection process from the water tower.

Here is a little test (contributed by Carol Fischer of the Library Staff) to review our readers' knowledge of Mountain View history during this Centennial year. Although several of the answers can be found in the book *Milestones: a History of Mountain View* by Mary Jo Ignoffo, see how many you can answer before checking the book. You will find the answers at the end of this column.

Centennial Test Questions

1. Was Mariano Castro the original recipient of Pastoria de las Borregas – the Mexican land grant that became Mountain View?
2. Who purchased nearly half of Rancho Pastoria de las Borregas in 1849?
3. What creek used to flood Castro Street?
4. Why is the owl the mascot of Foothill College?
5. What Mountain View citizen was credited with inventing baseball's spitball?
6. When was telephone service first established in Mountain View?
7. Between which decades did Mountain View experience its largest population jump?
8. What Mountain View High School graduate became a United States Senator from California?
9. What part of town was once considered Mountain View's Chinatown?
10. What was the name of the woman who promoted the establishment of Moffett Field?

Answers to the Centennial Questions:

1. The original recipient of Rancho Pastoria de las Borregas was Francisco Estrada. Governor Juan Alvarado granted Estrada the land grant in 1842. Francisco had married Inez Castro, the daughter of Mariano and Mariia Trinidad Castro in 1839. Unfortunately, the young couple died early: Inez in 1844 and Francisco in 1845. As they had no children, Francisco's father, Jose Mariano Estrada, inherited the land. He in turn sold the land to Inez' father, Mariano Castro.

2. In 1849 Mariano Castro sold a little over half of his 8,000+ acres to Martin Murphy, Jr. That portion of the rancho evolved into today's Sunnyvale.

3. Permanente Cree overflowed onto Castro Street. In 1878, toddler Willie Cooper was swept away by the pulsing creek. That incident sparked action and by 1880 Permanente Creek had been re-channeled and Castro Street remained dry during he rainy months.

4. The owl was the mascot of the Highway School, a grammar school located on El Camino Real and Calderon Avenue from 1928 until 1955. The building was then used as the first Foothill College while its campus was being constructed. In honor of their first home, Foothill College adopted the owl a its symbol.

5. Elmer Stricklett (1876-1964) is credited with inventing the spitball. Stricklett, a native of Kansas, was a professional baseball player who played for the Chicago White Sox and then for the Brooklyn Dodgers. His career lasted only three years, from 1904-1907. Elmer married Mabel Gates (1877-1968) and the couple eventually took over her parents' orchard on Caldeeron Avenue before retiring to the Santa Cruz are.

6. Telephone service began in Mountain View in 1894 with four subscribers. The exchange was located in Dr. Johnson's pharmacy on Castro Street. Miss Lizzie Martin was the first operator. The service grew gradually and by 1906, there were 85 Mountain view

subscribers.

7. Mountain View experienced two huge growth spurts. The largest of which occurred between 1950 and 1960 when the population boomed from 6,548 to 31,313 citizens. The second surge happened between 1960 and 1970 when the population shot from 31,313 to 54,132 people.

8. Alan Cranston, MVHS class of 1932 served as a United States Senator from California between 1968 and 1993. Senator Cranston died in 2000 at the age of 86.

9. Chinatown was located in the area of Villa and View Streets. Yuen Lung, who arrived from China in 1879, anchored the area with his merchandise store.

10. Laura Thane Whipple was the Alameda County real estate agent who was the first to promote the development of the airbase that became Moffett Field. The Navy had decided to establish a West Coast base for its new fleet of dirigibles. Mrs. Thane envisioned the base being built on the land once owned by the Ohlone, Lope Inigo. She convinced her client, Otto Hirsch, who one owned land a portion of the property that was to become the airbase, that this was the ideal location for such an undertaking. Mrs. Whipple then mustered and organized local realtors and Chambers of Commerce to support the idea. She enlisted the help of Congressman Arthur Free (a Mountain View man) who lent his encouragement in Washington D,C, Even Charles Lindbergh testified in favor of Mrs. Whipple's plan. By the end of December 1930, the airbase contract was awarded to the Mountain View – Sunnyvale location, beating out the rival San Diego site.

Notice — Dues are Due

Dues are now payable for the year 2003. The white mailing label on the outside of your Newsletter indicates the year thru which your dues are paid. The year is the number in the square brackets, for example [2002]. If the number 2003 or higher, your dues are paid. If the number is 2002 or lower, dues are due! The code in the adjacent brackets indicates your membership class. [AS] is single membership, $ 7.00 per year. [AF] is family membership, $ 10.00 per year. If your code is [LM], your dues are prepaid for life. A return Envelope is enclosed for your convenience. Thank you!

Treasurer's Report
Hilton Brown

The following tables summarize the financial condition of the Mountain View Historical Association as of September 30, 2002.

Income & Expense

Jan. 1, 2002 - Sept. 30, 2002

Opening Balance 1/1/02		$64,248.30
Income:		
Annual Dues	$ 1277.00	
Interest	926.02	
Book Sales	20,124.16	
Other Sales	91.20	
Special Events	1,835.36	
Cash Donations	33.00	
Total Income		24,286.74
Expense		
Bank Charges	18.70	
Bank Cards	89.47	
General Overhead	38.00	
Meet. & Memb.	210.45	
Promotion	441.91	
Newsletter	974.30	
Life Fund	93.00	
Adobe Fund	29.97	
Book Expense	32,087.45	
Total Expense		33,983.25
Ending Balance 9/30/02		$ 54,551.79

Fund Balances

September 30, 2002

Adobe Fund	$ 529.17
Life Member Fund	7,929.00
Memorial Fund	794.14
Operating Reserve	3,000.00
Publication Fund	35,103.51
Equity	7,195.97
Total Funds	$ 54,551.79

Don't Forget to Vote!
Tuesday
November 5, 2002